

Word family: **focus** / **focused** / **focussed** / **focusing** / **focussing** / **refocus** / **refocused** / **unfocused** / **focal**

Base word: focus

Verb forms: focus, focuses, focused/focussed, focusing/focussing

Noun: focus

Useful family extensions: refocus, unfocused/unfocussed, focal

Important compounds/expressions: focus on, focus attention on, in focus, out of focus, main focus, focal point, focal length, focus group, autofocus

Part of speech: verb (動詞) / noun (名詞)

Your sentence:

> “I still use them now, especially when I am travelling or trying to **focus**.”

A full family sweep shows that **focus** has one strong underlying idea: bringing attention, light, an image, or activity toward one clear central point. From that, we get several important modern uses. We should keep those connections visible rather than treating every context as unrelated.

Meaning in this passage

Here, **focus** means:

to direct and maintain your mental attention on what you are doing, without being distracted.

繁體中文: 把注意力集中在正在做的事情上，並盡量不受其他聲音、想法或活動干擾

Natural translation:

> “I still use them now, especially when I am travelling or trying to focus.”

「我現在仍然會使用它們，尤其是在旅行或**想集中精神／專心**的時候。」

So:

focus = 集中注意力；專心

1. **focus** (注意力／精神) — 集中精神；專心

This is your original meaning.

Meaning: To direct your mental attention toward one task, idea, or activity.

Practice 1 — Original

> “I use the headphones when I am trying to **focus**.”

「我想**集中精神／專心**的時候會使用這副耳機。」

Practice 2

> “It is difficult to **focus** when the office is noisy.”

「辦公室很嘈雜時，很難**集中精神**。」

Practice 3

> “Take a short break if you can’t **focus**.”

「如果你無法**專心**，可以先休息一下。」

focus = 把自己的注意力集中起來，不讓其他事情分散精神

2. **focus on** + task/topic/person (工作／話題／對象) — 專注於……; 集中注意力在……

This is one of the most important patterns.

Practice 4

> “I need to **focus on** my work.”

「我需要**專心工作／把注意力集中在工作上**。」

Practice 5

> “The discussion **focused on** customer satisfaction.”

「討論**集中在顧客滿意度這個議題上**。」

focus on something = 把主要注意力、時間或討論集中在某個特定對象上

Notice that the subject can be:

* a person → **I focus on my work**

* a discussion/report/course → **The report focuses on safety**

So it does not always mean literal mental concentration by one person.

3. **focus + attention/effort/resources on + target (注意力／努力／資源) — 把.....集中在.....**

Here, **focus** is transitive.

Practice 6

> “We need to **focus our attention on** the main problem.”

「我們需要**把注意力集中在主要問題上**。」

Practice 7

> “The company is **focusing its resources on** new technology.”

「公司正**把資源集中投放在新科技上**。」

focus something on something = 有意識地把注意力、努力、資源或活動集中到特定目標

Common objects:

* focus your **attention**

* focus your **efforts**

* focus your **energy**

* focus your **resources**

4. **focus = main subject/priority (名詞) — 重點;焦點;主要關注事項**

Meaning: The main thing receiving attention or considered most important.

Practice 8

> “Comfort was the main **focus** of the design.”

「舒適度是這個設計的主要**重點**。」

Practice 9

> “The **focus** of the meeting was customer service.”

「會議的**焦點／主要議題**是顧客服務。」

focus — noun = 在一件事情中最受重視、最值得注意或最主要的部分

5. **focus of attention/interest**(注意／興趣) — 焦點; 中心人物／事物

Practice 10

> “The new product became the **focus of attention**.”

「這款新產品成為大家**關注的焦點**。」

Practice 11

> “She suddenly found herself the **focus of attention**.”

「她突然發現自己成為眾人**注意的焦點**。」

focus of attention = 所有人或大量注意力集中之處／對象

This belongs to the same “central point” concept as #4.

6. **bring/shift/change the focus to + topic**(話題／優先事項) — 把焦點轉向.....

Practice 12

> “The discussion later **shifted its focus to** cost.”

「討論之後**把焦點轉向成本問題**。」

Practice 13

> “We should **bring the focus back to** the customer.”

「我們應該**把焦點重新放回顧客身上**。」

shift/change the focus = 改變目前主要注意或討論的對象

7. ****camera/lens focus (相機／鏡頭) — 對焦; 使影像清晰****

This is a major literal/technical meaning.

****Meaning:**** To adjust a lens so that an image becomes sharp and clear.

Practice 14

> “The camera ****focused**** on her face.”

「相機在她的臉上****完成對焦****。」

Practice 15

> “You need to ****focus**** the lens before taking the picture.”

「拍照之前需要先把鏡頭****對焦****。」

****focus — camera/lens = 調整鏡頭, 使目標影像形成清晰而銳利的畫面****

8. ****in focus / out of focus (影像) — 對焦清晰／失焦模糊****

Practice 16

> “Her face is perfectly ****in focus****.”

「她的臉****對焦清晰****。」

Practice 17

> “The background is slightly ****out of focus****.”

「背景有點****失焦模糊****。」

****in focus = 鏡頭正確對焦, 影像清楚****

****out of focus = 沒有正確對焦, 影像模糊****

These are extremely common in photography and video.

9. **focus light/rays**(光線／光束) — 聚焦;把光集中於一點

This is the physical/optical origin of the word.

Practice 18

> “The lens **focuses** light onto the sensor.”

「鏡頭把光線**聚焦**到感光元件上。」

Practice 19

> “The mirror **focused** the sunlight onto a small area.”

「鏡子把陽光**集中／聚焦**在一小塊範圍上。」

focus light = 使原本分散的光線匯聚到一個特定位置

This physical idea helps explain the figurative mental meaning:

> light converges on one point

> → attention converges on one task

10. **focus** = point where light/rays meet(光學) — 焦點

Here, **focus** is a noun in optics.

Practice 20

> “The rays meet at the **focus**.”

「光線在**焦點**匯聚。」

Practice 21

> “The image forms near the **focus** of the lens.”

「影像在鏡頭的**焦點**附近形成。」

focus — optics = 光線經反射或折射後匯聚的點

This is a genuinely technical noun meaning, but common enough to recognize.

11. **focus** = clarity/direction in an idea, plan, or piece of writing — 明確重點; 清晰方向

Meaning: A clear sense of what something is mainly about or trying to achieve.

Practice 22

> “The essay lacks **focus**.”

「這篇文章**缺乏明確重點**, 內容不夠集中。」

Practice 23

> “The project needs a clearer **focus**.”

「這個專案需要一個更**清晰明確的方向／重點**。」

focus = 內容、計劃或思路有清楚的中心和方向, 不會過分分散

This develops naturally from the “central point” meaning.

12. **focused** = concentrating strongly (人) — 專注的; 精神集中的

Practice 24

> “She remained **focused** despite the noise.”

「雖然很嘈雜, 她仍然保持**專注**。」

Practice 25

> “I feel more **focused** when I wear these headphones.”

「我戴著這副耳機時覺得自己**更能集中精神**。」

focused — person = 注意力集中在目標上, 不容易被其他事情分散

13. **focused = clearly directed toward a goal (計劃／工作／方法) — 目標明確的; 集中於特定目的的**

Practice 26

> “We need a more **focused** strategy.”

「我們需要一套**目標更明確、更集中的策略**。」

Practice 27

> “The course offers **focused** training in communication skills.”

「這個課程提供**針對溝通技巧的集中培訓**。」

focused — plan/activity = 清楚集中在某個特定目標或範圍, 而不是過分廣泛分散的

14. **unfocused / unfocussed = unable to concentrate (人／思緒) — 無法專心的; 注意力渙散的**

Practice 28

> “I felt tired and **unfocused**.”

「我感到很累, 而且**注意力渙散、無法專心**。」

Practice 29

> “His thoughts seemed **unfocused**.”

「他的思緒似乎**很分散、沒有清晰方向**。」

unfocused = 注意力、思考或活動沒有集中在清楚的目標上

15. **unfocused = image not sharply focused (影像) — 失焦的; 模糊的**

Practice 30

> “The photograph is slightly **unfocused**.”

「這張照片有點**失焦／不夠清晰**。」

Practice 31

> “The camera produced several ****unfocused**** images.”

「相機拍出了幾張****失焦模糊的照片****。」

Same underlying concept:

****not brought into a clear focus****

16. ****refocus = concentrate again / redirect attention — 重新集中精神; 重新調整重點****

A very useful family extension.

Practice 32

> “After the break, I was able to ****refocus****.”

「休息過後, 我能夠****重新集中精神****。」

Practice 33

> “The company decided to ****refocus its efforts on**** customer service.”

「公司決定****重新把工作重點集中在顧客服務上****。」

****refocus = 原本注意力／方向被分散或放在其他地方後, 重新集中到某個目標****

17. ****refocus camera/lens (鏡頭) — 重新對焦****

Practice 34

> “The camera automatically ****refocused**** on the moving subject.”

「相機自動對移動中的主體****重新對焦****。」

Practice 35

> “I had to ****refocus**** the lens.”

「我必須把鏡頭**重新對焦**。」

Again, this is the same core concept applied physically.

18. **focal = central/most important (中心／重點) — 核心的; 焦點的**

Focal is an important lexical family member.

Practice 36

> “The fireplace is the **focal point** of the room.”

「壁爐是房間的**視覺焦點／中心位置**。」

Practice 37

> “Education became a **focal issue** in the discussion.”

「教育成為討論中的**核心議題**。」

focal = 位於中心、最值得注意, 或成為其他事物集中之處的

19. **focal point = centre of attention/visual interest — 焦點; 中心**

A particularly useful fixed expression.

Practice 38

> “The painting became the **focal point** of the room.”

「那幅畫成為房間的**視覺焦點**。」

Practice 39

> “Customer experience should be the **focal point** of the strategy.”

「顧客體驗應該成為這套策略的**核心重點**。」

focal point = 視覺、注意力或活動最集中、最重要的中心

20. **focal length (攝影／光學) — 焦距**

A useful technical family extension.

Practice 40

> “A longer **focal length** makes distant objects appear larger.”

「較長的**焦距**會令遠處物體看起來更大。」

Practice 41

> “This lens has a fixed **focal length**.”

「這個鏡頭具有固定**焦距**。」

focal length = 鏡頭／光學系統中與成像和視角有關的焦距

21. **focus group (市場研究／研究) — 焦點小組；焦點團體**

This is an important modern compound.

Meaning: A small group of selected people brought together to discuss and give opinions about a product, idea, advertisement, service, etc.

Practice 42

> “The company tested the advertisement with a **focus group**.”

「公司透過一個**焦點小組**測試這則廣告。」

Practice 43

> “Participants in the **focus group** preferred the simpler design.”

「**焦點小組**的參與者較喜歡較簡單的設計。」

focus group = 為研究消費者／參與者的態度和意見而召集的小組討論

This is especially relevant to advertising and marketing.

22. **autofocus**(相機) — 自動對焦

Another useful modern family extension.

Practice 44

> “The camera has fast **autofocus**.”

「這部相機具有快速的**自動對焦功能**。」

Practice 45

> “The **autofocus** struggled in low light.”

「在低光環境下，**自動對焦系統**表現不太理想。」

autofocus = 相機自動調整鏡頭，使拍攝主體清晰的功能／系統

23. **focus of infection/disease**(醫學) — 病灶；感染焦點

A common enough medical use to recognize, though not core everyday vocabulary.

Practice 46

> “Doctors identified the **focus of infection**.”

「醫生找到了感染的**病灶／感染源集中位置**。」

Practice 47

> “The scan showed a small **focus** of abnormal tissue.”

「掃描顯示有一小處**異常組織病灶**。」

focus — medical = 疾病、感染或異常變化集中出現的一個局部位置

This still comes from the idea of a **localized central point**.

Important distinction: **focus vs concentrate**

They overlap strongly.

focus

often emphasizes directing attention toward a particular target.

> “Focus on the question.”

「把注意力放在問題上。」

concentrate

often emphasizes making a mental effort not to be distracted.

> “I can’t concentrate because of the noise.”

「因為噪音，我無法集中精神。」

In your sentence:

> “trying to focus”

and:

> “trying to concentrate”

would both be natural.

Important distinction: **focus on vs pay attention to**

focus on

usually means sustained, concentrated attention.

pay attention to

means notice/listen/watch carefully.

> “Pay attention to the instructions.”

「留意／仔細聽指示。」

> “Focus on the most important task.”

「集中精神處理最重要的工作。」

You can **pay attention** briefly, whereas **focus** often suggests maintaining concentration.

Important distinction: **focus vs attention**

focus

can be the act/state/direction of concentrating.

attention

is the mental awareness being directed.

> “I need to focus.”

「我需要集中精神。」

> “This requires my full attention.”

「這件事需要我全神貫注。」

Common combination:

> **focus your attention on something**

= **把注意力集中在某事上**

Important distinction: **focus vs priority**

focus

= what receives most attention

****priority****

= what is considered more important and should be dealt with first

> “Our focus is customer experience.”

「我們主要關注顧客體驗。」

> “Safety is our top priority.”

「安全是我們的首要事項。」

Something can be a ****focus**** without necessarily being the ****highest priority****.

Important distinction: ****focus vs focal point****

****focus****

very broad:

- * concentration
- * central subject
- * optical focus

****focal point****

specifically means:

****the central point attracting attention or organizing other elements****

> “The sofa is the focal point of the room.”

「沙發是房間的視覺中心。」

Important spelling note: ****focused/focussed****

Both spellings exist.

Common American English:

- * focused

* focusing

British English:

Both forms occur:

* focused / focusing

* focussed / focussing

The single-**s** forms **focused / focusing** are now also very common in British English.

Likewise:

* unfocused

* unfocussed

Both may appear.

Important grammar note: **focus on**, not normally **focus in**

For attention:

> “Focus **on** your work.” 

Not normally:

> “Focus **in** your work.” 

Similarly:

> “The article focuses **on** advertising.”

However:

> “The camera focused **in on** his face.”

can occur as a separate construction meaning the camera/attention narrowed toward one particular target. For our normal vocabulary work, **focus on** is the essential pattern.

Family-extension sweep

After the full sweep, the useful modern family includes:

- * **focus — mental** = 集中精神／專心
- * **focus on** = 專注於.....
- * **focus attention/effort/resources on** = 把注意力／努力／資源集中在.....
- * **focus — noun** = 重點／焦點
- * **focus of attention** = 注意焦點
- * **focus — camera/lens** = 對焦
- * **in focus** = 對焦清晰
- * **out of focus** = 失焦模糊
- * **focus light** = 聚焦光線
- * **focus — optics** = 焦點
- * **focus — clarity/direction** = 清楚的重點／方向
- * **focused** = 專注的; 目標集中的
- * **unfocused/unfocussed** = 無法專心的; 沒有清楚方向的; 失焦的
- * **refocus** = 重新集中／重新對焦
- * **focal** = 核心的／焦點的
- * **focal point** = 焦點／中心
- * **focal length** = 焦距
- * **focus group** = 焦點小組
- * **autofocus** = 自動對焦
- * **focus — medical** = 病灶／局部異常焦點

I would exclude rare technical derivatives unless the lesson moves specifically into optics or medicine.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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focus — mental	把自己的注意力集中起來, 不讓其他事情分散精神
focus on + target	把主要注意力、時間或活動集中在某個特定對象上
focus attention/effort on	有意識地把注意力、努力或資源集中到指定目標
focus — main subject	一件事情中最受重視、最主要的議題或部分
focus of attention	大量注意力集中之處／對象
focus — camera/lens	調整鏡頭, 使拍攝目標形成清晰影像
in focus	鏡頭正確對焦, 因此影像清晰
out of focus	沒有正確對焦, 因此影像模糊
focus light	使分散的光線匯聚到特定位置
focus — optics	光線經反射或折射後匯聚的焦點
focus — clarity/direction	文章、計劃或活動具有清楚的中心和方向
focused — person	注意力集中、不容易受到其他事情干擾的

focused — strategy/activity	清楚集中在特定目標或範圍的	
unfocused	注意力／思路沒有集中, 或影像沒有清楚對焦的	
refocus	注意力或方向被分散後重新集中; 亦可指鏡頭重新對焦	
focal	位於中心、最值得注意或成為其他事物集中之處的	
focal point	視覺、注意力或活動最集中、最重要的中心	
focal length	光學系統中影響成像與視角的焦距	
focus group	為了解目標群體意見而召集進行討論的小型研究群組	
autofocus	相機自動調整鏡頭使拍攝主體清晰的功能	
focus — medical	疾病、感染或異常組織集中出現的局部位置／病灶	

For your original sentence

> “I still use them now, especially when I am travelling or trying to ****focus****.”

The exact meaning is:

****focus = 把注意力集中在自己正在做的事情上, 避免被外界噪音或其他干擾分散精神****

So:

> ****trying to focus****

= ****「努力想集中精神／努力想專心」****

And this connects perfectly with the role of the noise-cancelling headphones: they reduce outside distractions, making it easier for the speaker to ****maintain concentration****.